

PI Planning Checklist

Note:

This checklist aligns with SAFe PI Planning guidelines and can be customized based on your organization's specific needs and context. Remember, if you're not doing PI Planning, you're not doing SAFe.

Pre-PI Planning

(For Solution Train Level)

- ☐ Schedule pre-PI planning event
- ☐ Invite required roles:
 - ☐ Solution Train Engineer
 - ☐ Solution Management
 - ☐ Solution Architect/Engineering
 - ☐ Solution System Team
 - ☐ Release Train Engineers
 - ☐ Product Management
 - ☐ System Architects/Engineers
 - ☐ Customers
- ☐ Review Solution Backlog
- ☐ Update Solution Intent
- ☐ Prepare Solution Vision
- ☐ Review Solution Roadmap

Event Preparation

(2-3 Weeks Before)

Logistics & Tools

- ☐ Schedule PI Planning for 2 full days
- ☐ Confirm 8-12 week increment timeline
- ☐ Set up Jira or preferred planning tool
- ☐ Create digital Program Board (if using)
- ☐ Prepare confidence voting mechanism
- ☐ Arrange facilities for in-person attendees
- ☐ Set up remote participation tools

Content Preparation

- ☐ Business context presentation
- ☐ Product/Solution vision updates
- ☐ Architecture vision and development practices
- ☐ Program backlog prioritization
- ☐ Previous PI accomplishments summary
- ☐ Draft PI and Solution roadmaps

PI Planning Checklist

Day 1 Agenda Checklist

(Standard Timing)

Morning Sessions

Business Context (8:00 - 9:00)

- ☐ Senior Executive/Business Owner presenter ready
- ☐ Current business state overview prepared
- ☐ Customer needs analysis ready
- ☐ Product gap analysis prepared

Product/Solution Vision (9:00 - 10:30)

- ☐ Product Management presentation ready
- ☐ Vision changes documented
- ☐ Next 10 features identified
- ☐ Upcoming milestones listed

Architecture Vision (10:30 - 11:30)

- ☐ Technical presentation prepared
- ☐ Development practices overview ready

Planning Context & Lunch (11:30 - 13:00)

- ☐ Context materials distributed
- ☐ Lunch arrangements confirmed

Afternoon Sessions

Team Breakouts (13:00 - 16:00)

- ☐ Team spaces assigned
- ☐ Planning tools accessible
- ☐ Product Owners available
- ☐ Scrum Masters prepared

Draft Plan Review (16:00 - 17:00)

- ☐ Teams ready to present
- ☐ Dependencies identified
- ☐ Risks documented

Management Review (17:00 - 18:00)

- ☐ Business Owners available
- ☐ Problem-solving process ready

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Day 2 Agenda Checklist

(Standard Timing)

Morning Sessions

Planning Adjustments (8:00 - 9:00)

- ☐ Previous day's feedback incorporated
- ☐ Adjustment time allocated

Team Breakouts (9:00 - 11:00)

- ☐ Teams finalizing plans
- ☐ Dependencies resolved

Final Plan Review (11:00 - 13:00)

- ☐ Updated plans ready
- ☐ Cross-team dependencies confirmed

Afternoon Sessions

Program Risks (13:00 - 14:00)

- ☐ Risk assessment complete
- ☐ Mitigation strategies identified

Confidence Vote (14:00 - 14:15)

- ☐ Voting mechanism ready
- ☐ Process explained
- ☐ Minimum 3/5 target understood

Plan Rework (if needed)

- ☐ Rework areas identified
- ☐ Teams available

Planning Retrospective

- ☐ Feedback format prepared
- ☐ Action items captured

PI Planning Checklist

Role-Specific Responsibilities

Release Train Engineer

- ☐ Facilitate PI Planning event
- ☐ Manage annual calendars
- ☐ Create Program PI Objectives
- ☐ Track progress
- ☐ Lead system demos

Scrum Master

- ☐ Facilitate team preparation
- ☐ Help estimate capacity
- ☐ Manage timeboxes
- ☐ Support dependency management
- ☐ Prepare system demos

Product Manager

- ☐ Present program vision
- ☐ Define milestones
- ☐ Review draft plans
- ☐ Update roadmap
- ☐ Create Solution PI Objectives

Developer

- ☐ Research and design
- ☐ Create user stories
- ☐ Define acceptance criteria
- ☐ Identify risks/dependencies
- ☐ Participate in confidence vote

Product Owner

- ☐ Maintain Team Backlog
- ☐ Lead Iteration Planning
- ☐ Make story-level decisions
- ☐ Draft Team PI Objectives
- ☐ Participate in confidence vote

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Remote/Hybrid Considerations

- ☐ Cloud-based tools ready
- ☐ Livestream setup tested
- ☐ Recording capability confirmed
- ☐ Multiple timezone adjustments made
- ☐ Clear communication protocols established

Post-PI Planning

- ☐ Schedule post-PI planning event
- ☐ Conduct planning retrospective
- ☐ Document what went well/poorly
- ☐ Transfer program board to work management tool
- ☐ Schedule iteration planning meetings
- ☐ Set up daily stand-ups
- ☐ Clean up event spaces

Using Jira for PI Planning

If you're using Jira for team-level agile management, Easy Agile Programs can help you scale to program-level planning.

Instead of recreating sticky notes and stringing in Jira after your PI Planning session, use Easy Agile Programs to run your planning session directly in Jira. You'll get a digital Program Board, cross-team planning capabilities, dependency management, and real-time collaboration - all integrated with your existing Jira projects.

Join companies like Bell, Cisco, and Deutsche Bahn who use Easy Agile Programs from the Atlassian Marketplace to transform Jira into an effective PI Planning tool.



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